25900476

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCJMC203 - TRANSLATION AND JOURNALISTIC WRITING

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse (An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions. Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 mark

1. c) Google Translate [K] / [CO1]
2. c) To persuade and connect with the target audience emotionally and culturally[A] / [CO2]
3. a) Personal bias of the individual writer [U] / [CO4, CO5]
4. b) Formal, clear, and reader-friendly [U] / [CO4, CO5]
5. b) Offer in-depth background, analysis, and human interest [U] / [CO4, CO5]
6. a) The opinion/editorial page [U] / [CO4, CO5]
7. c) Functional equivalence [U] / [CO1]
8. a) Giving equal importance to all sides of an issue [U] / [CO4, CO5]
9. b) Source Language Text analysis [U] / [CO1]
10. b) Recreating the same impact or effect in the target audience [U] / [CO2]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions (100 Words)

Answer any 10 questions. Each question carries 3 marks

11. Creative writing in the media industry helps produce engaging, original, and impactful content across platforms like advertising, television, digital media, journalism, and film. It enhances storytelling, captures audience interest, builds emotional connection, and adds artistic value to factual or promotional messages. Creative writing also strengthens brand identity, improves message recall, and allows media professionals to communicate complex ideas in accessible and imaginative ways. [U] / [CO1]

12. Literal translation is a word-for-word rendering of a source text, preserving original structure and vocabulary as closely as possible. In journalism, it is used when accuracy and neutrality

are crucial—such as translating official statements, legal documents, speeches, data, and direct quotes—where altering wording may change meaning or cause misinterpretation. [U] / [CO3]

13. Engagement refers to the level of interaction users have with social media content. It includes likes, comments, shares, saves, clicks, reactions, and time spent viewing. High engagement indicates that the content is relevant, relatable, and effective in prompting user participation, discussions, or community building. [An] / [CO4, CO5]

14. Translation enables global news organizations to gather, distribute, and share information across linguistic boundaries. It ensures fast dissemination of worldwide events, helps maintain accuracy while reporting international stories, and allows news agencies to reach diverse audiences. Translation supports cross-cultural understanding, reduces misinformation, and strengthens global connectivity in journalism. [U] / [CO1]

15. Intersemiotic translation (Roman Jakobson) refers to translating meaning from one sign system to another—not between languages, but between different modes such as text, image, sound, or film.
    Examples: A novel adapted into a film, A poem turned into a painting or music, A news report converted into an infographic, A historical event represented as a documentary. [U] / [CO1]

16. Creative writing is a form of expressive writing that uses imagination, narrative craft, and artistic techniques to convey ideas, emotions, and stories. It includes genres such as fiction, poetry, drama, scripts, and personal essays. It emphasizes originality, figurative language, character development, and engaging storytelling. [U] / [CO4, CO5]

17. **Gatekeeping:**
    The selection, filtering, and control of news content by editors or journalists. In translation, gatekeeping decides which foreign stories are chosen, what information is included or excluded, and how content aligns with editorial policies.
    Trans editing:
    A blend of translation, editing, and rewriting. Journalists modify the original text to suit space limits, cultural expectations, style guidelines, or clarity requirements. It may involve summarizing, reorganizing, simplifying, or adapting content to fit the target audience and medium. [U] / [CO1]

18. Audience diversity influences translators to adapt language, tone, cultural references, and examples to ensure comprehension across varied demographic, linguistic, and cultural groups. They may avoid idioms, simplify complex terms, provide context, and maintain neutral or inclusive language to cater to multicultural and multilingual audiences. [K] / [CO3]

19. Timing determines the length, pace, and structure of broadcast scripts. Writers must ensure that content fits strict time slots and is delivered at a pace suitable for listeners/viewers. [An] / [CO4, CO5]

20. CAT tools assist human translators using technology such as translation memory, terminology databases, and alignment tools. Advantages include: Faster translation with increased efficiency- Consistency in terminology and phrasing-Reduced errors- Reuse of previous translations-better collaboration among translators-Ability to handle large projects systematically. [U] / [CO1]
21. Cultural references may not have direct equivalents in the target language, making subtitle translation challenging. Translators must adapt, simplify, or replace references with culturally

understandable alternatives while preserving meaning. Misalignment can cause confusion or loss of humour, emotion, or context. Space and time constraints in subtitles make this adaptation even more crucial. [U] / [CO3]

22. Personal voice in column writing adds individuality, perspective, and emotion to a writer's opinion. It differentiates the columnist's style, builds reader trust, and creates a recognizable persona. Personal voice allows use of humor, anecdotes, rhetorical devices, and subjective interpretation to engage readers and make commentary more relatable and persuasive. [E] / [CO4, CO5]

[3x10 = 30]

Part C

Essay Type Questions (450 Words)

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

23. **Process:**
Idea selection-Research (primary & secondary)-Decide angle/focus-Outline/structureAttractive lead-Body with facts, quotes, descriptions-Conclusion with message/impactEditing & fact-checking
Categorization: Human-interest-Profile-Informative/explanatory-Historical-Lifestyle-Science & tech-Cultural-Investigative etc.[U] / [CO4, CO5]

24. Makes global media accessible (subtitles, dubbing, multilingual news)-Promotes cross-cultural understanding-Supports international journalism (wire reports, global news flow)-Expands global entertainment markets (films, OTT, music)-Enables digital knowledge exchange (research, e-learning)-Helps social media interaction across languages. [U] / [CO1]

25. A translator in journalism does more than convert words from one language to another—they interpret cultural meanings so that the audience truly understands the message- explains cultural references, idioms, metaphors-Provides contextual meaning beyond literal translation-Ensures cultural sensitivity (religion, caste, politics)-Adapts tone/style for target audience-Prevents cultural distortion or stereotypes. [An] / [CO3]

26. Clarity and simplicity are essential qualities of journalistic writing today: Readers Have Short Attention Spans-Information Overload- Straightforward writing helps the story stand out. Mobile-First Consumption-Global Readership-News reaches multilingual audiences. Clear, direct sentences improve visibility and ranking on search platforms-Accuracy and Transparency-Social Media Sharing-Inclusivity etc. [E] / [CO4, CO5]

[15x2 = 30]